

Training Plan

Nivish

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Training Plan — No Bar, Full Bodyweight, Rain-Proof

Revised June 2026 from your Strava data: zone-2 base rebuild after a 5-month grey-zone plateau, sequenced around a current tibialis (shin) strain.

⚠ Read first — current shin strain

Front-of-shin muscle (tibialis anterior) tight after cold max broad-jumps; lifting the foot up is restricted. Until it moves freely and is pain-free:

- **No running. No jumping/plyometrics (broad jumps OUT).** No sprint finishes.
- Upper-body Push & Skill work can continue (doesn't load the shin) — pain-free only.
- Your own tibialis raises / soleus holds / foot intrinsics become **active rehab** — do them gently now.
- **See a physio if:** still tight/worse after 1–2 weeks, pain *on the bone*, swelling, or pain at rest/night.

Pace zones (estimated — no HR in your data, so a map not gospel)

Zone	Use	Pace (min/km)	Talk test
Zone 2	Easy — 80% of running	7:45 – 8:00	Full sentences
Zone 3 ⚠	AVOID (the trap you were stuck in)	6:55 – 7:30	A few words
Zone 4	Threshold / quality run	6:30 – 6:50	Comfortably hard
Zone 5	Intervals, short reps	6:00 – 6:20	Can't talk

If you now record HR, use it (zone 2 $\approx$ 120–140 bpm for many) and tell me — I'll recalibrate these to your real numbers. Until then, **talk test wins**.

Golden rules

1. **Finish easy** — last km = first km. No sprint finishes (your splits showed 4:51 finishes; stop).
2. **80% of running is zone 2.** Easy means easy.

3. **One hard run per week max — and only in Phase 3.**
 4. **No explosive work cold.** Always warm up; build it in small doses.
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Weekly structure (unchanged — your split is good)

- Day 1 – Push
- Day 2 – Run + Core + Neck
- Day 3 – Pull (floor) + Legs + Knees
- Day 4 – Run + Core + Neck
- Day 5 – Full Body Skill
- Day 6 – Run + Core + Neck
- Day 7 – Rest

The three RUN days change by phase (below). Strength days stay as written, with the two edits flagged ♦ .

DAY 1 – PUSH

- Explosive Push-Up — 3x5. ♦ **While injured / first weeks back: fast push-ups with max intent instead** (no jump). Return to explosive once healed.
- Archer Push-Up — 3x4/side (left leads)
- Pike Push-Up, feet elevated, 3-sec eccentric — 3x5
- Diamond Push-Up — 3x6
- Pseudo Planche Lean Hold — 3x15 sec
- Fingertip OR Towel Push-Up — 3x8 (left-hand focus)

DAY 2 – RUN + CORE + NECK

Run — all phases: Easy Zone 2, 7:45–8:00, finish easy.

- Phase 1: 20–25 min (build to 30). Rain: skip run, +10 min core as slow controlled work.
- Core/Neck: Dead Bug 3x6/side · Copenhagen Plank 3x20 sec · Neck Flexion+Extension (hand resistance) 3x12 each.

DAY 3 – PULL (FLOOR) + LEGS + KNEES

- Superman Hold + Scapular Squeeze — 3×10 (2-sec hold)
- Reverse Snow Angel (prone) — 3×12
- Australian Pull-Up (table) OR bedsheet row — 3×8
- ♦ **Broad Jump — REMOVED until shin pain-free.** Reintroduce in Phase 2 progressively (pogo hops → bounds → broad jumps). Never cold.
- Bulgarian Split Squat (left leads) — 3×6/side
- Single-Leg RDL (bodyweight, left leads) — 3×6/side

Knee block — every Day 3 and Day 5, no skipping:

- Spanish Squat OR Wall Sit, toes elevated — 3×30 sec
- Terminal Knee Extension (band) OR Slow Straight-Leg Raise — 3×15

DAY 4 – RUN + CORE + NECK

Run — phase-dependent:

- **Phase 1 (base, ~8 weeks): Easy Zone 2, 25–30 min, then 4×15-sec relaxed strides** (~80%, NOT max), full walk recovery. Strides safely feed your explosiveness urge. *No 1-min hard intervals yet — that repeats the plateau.*
- **Phase 3 (after base + healed):** the interval day returns — warmup walk → 4–5×1 min hard (Zone 5, 6:00–6:20) → 2 min walk → cooldown. Build interval count back up slowly.
- Core/Neck: Hanging Knee Raise 3×8 (or Dragon Flag Negative 3×5) · Back Extension/Superman 3×12 · Neck Lateral Flexion 3×10/side.

DAY 5 – FULL BODY SKILL

- Wall Handstand Hold (chest to wall) — 3×20 sec
- Tuck Planche Lean OR Tuck L-Sit — 3×10–15 sec
- Pseudo Planche Push-Up — 3×4
- External Rotation (water bottle, left leads) — 3×12
- Wall Sit, toes elevated — 3×30 sec
- Foot Intrinsic — Towel Scrunch OR Short Foot — 3×20 (*do these now — direct shin/arch rehab*)

DAY 6 – RUN + CORE + NECK

Run — all phases: Long Easy Zone 2, conversational throughout.

- Phase 1: 35–45 min easy. Rain: 30 min brisk walk + core only.
- Core/Neck: Plank Shoulder Tap 3×8/side · **Tibialis Raises 3×20** · **Soleus Hold 3×40 sec** · Chin Tuck with Resistance 3×12. (*Tibialis + soleus are your shin rehab — prioritise them now.*)

DAY 7 – REST

Phase map

- **Phase 0 (now):** shin rehab. Strength upper/skill OK pain-free; no running, no jumping.
- **Phase 1 (~8 weeks back):** 3 runs/week ALL easy zone 2 (Days 2, 4-with-strides, 6). No intervals, no broad jumps yet.
- **Phase 2 (after ~3–4 weeks pain-free):** reintroduce explosiveness progressively — pogo hops + skipping → bounds → broad jumps. Explosive push-ups return.
- **Phase 3 (after 8+ weeks base, fully healed):** Day 4 becomes the one quality/interval run. Everything else stays easy.

The 8-week test

Does **7:50/km feel easier**, or can you hold it longer than before? That's the aerobic engine the hard months never built.